

Digital Cameras

Facing trouble with your digicam? Whether it's making the digicam work in sync with the PC or fungus on the lens, read on for help

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Your Digital Camera Does Not Get Detected

Problem: Sometimes, in Windows XP or other operating systems, your digital camera does not get detected as a device attached to the computer.

Solution: Here's a brief list of what you can do to troubleshoot this situation.

- Under Windows XP, a digicam should get detected quite easily, but with older OSes, you should connect the device and install the drivers and software exactly in the order specified in the manual. Uninstall the software and drivers and try doing it again, paying attention to the order of events.

- Make sure your OS supports the devices—some devices are incompatible with certain OSes. For example, the JDC15 digicam does not work with Windows 95 or 2000.

- First switch on the camera before plugging it into the USB port on the PC. Failing that, Windows may be unable to properly recognise the device or drivers. If the camera is not turned on before plugging it in, the camera might be detected as an Unknown Device.

- Turn the camera off and then on again.

- Try setting the camera to 'image viewing mode'.

- Check the USB cable connection.

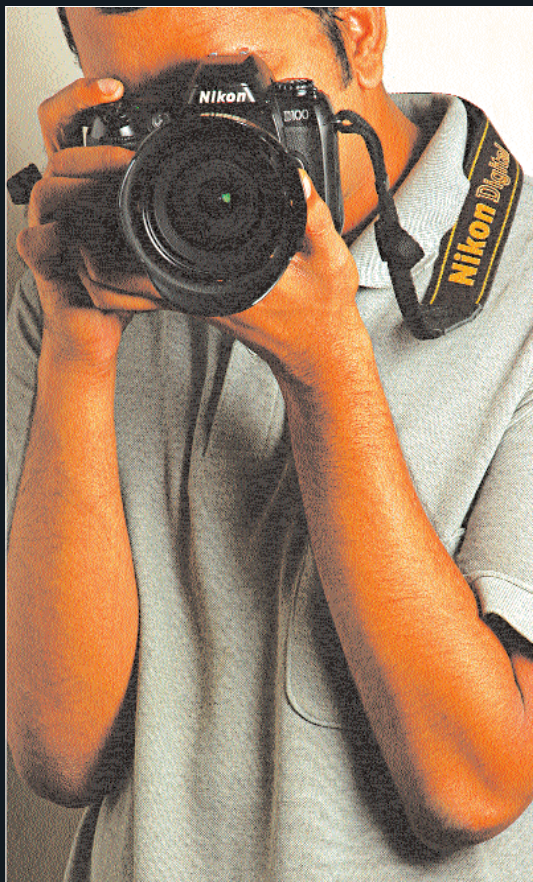
- Check that the USB port is working fine. Attach something else to the port, such as a mouse or a scanner.

- Connect the camera to a different computer and check.

- Reinstall the WIA or TWAIN drivers

for the camera. If you don't have them on your computer, you can probably download them off the manufacturer's Web site.

- Finally, try this: if the camera can record images to a removable memory card, use a memory card reader to transfer the files to the computer. If you can't transfer the images from a memory card, the memory card may be the cause of the problem. If you can transfer the images from a memory card, it may be the camera that is at fault.



The correct way to hold a camera: arms tucked in, with one hand supporting the camera while you click with the other

Images Are Blurred

Problem: Images can turn out blurred for a variety of reasons. These include inaccurate focus, camera shake, or a dirty lens.

Solution:

- Inaccurate focus:** This may happen if you don't hold the shutter release button halfway down until the picture is taken. Or, you may be focusing and then changing your distance from the subject without refocusing. Change these habits. Use the 'Focus Lock' feature if your camera has it, and then ensure that your distance from the subject does not change from the time you lock focus until you take the image.

If you're using an auto-focus system, you may have trouble focusing when there is not much colour difference between the foreground and background; in front of or behind bars, such as a cage or railing; on shiny and opaque surfaces; and on subjects photographed through glass.

- Camera shake:** Shaky hands are bad news when you're using a digital camera. Practise holding the camera steady in a relaxed but controlled posture, and press the shutter release with steady, gentle pressure.

Your elbows must be held firmly against your body, to ensure that the hand holding the camera is steady. However, a posture that is too rigid may also cause your body and the camera to shake.

For exposures slower than 1/30th of a second, use a tripod, or set the camera on a sturdy surface. In addition, use a cable release or remote control to avoid shaking the